

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS-----X  
Saqis Samuel,: Index Number:  
: Date Purchased:  
: Date Filed:

Plaintiff

: SUMMONS

-against- :

City of New York, New York City Police Department, :  
Police Officer Stephanie Perez, Shield 26230 of the 77 :  
Precinct, Police Officer Tiffany Martinez, Shield 2382 of :  
the 77 Precinct and New York City Police Officers John :  
Doe, :Plaintiff's residence is:  
: 66 Herzl Street  
: Brooklyn, NY 11212

Defendants :

-----X  
TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the incident occurred in Kings County.

Dated: September 24, 2020  
Bronx, NY

Yours, etc.,

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H  
Bronx, NY 10451  
(718) 585-2833

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Police Officer Stephanie Perez, Shield 26230 of the 77 Precinct

Police Officer Tiffany Martinez, Shield 2382 of 77 Precinct

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

|                                                           |                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| -----X                                                    |                      |
| Saquis Samuel,                                            | :                    |
|                                                           | :                    |
| Plaintiff,                                                | :                    |
|                                                           | :                    |
|                                                           | : VERIFIED COMPLAINT |
| -against-                                                 | :                    |
|                                                           | :                    |
| City of New York, New York City Police Department,        | :                    |
| Police Officer Stephanie Perez, Shield 26230 of the 77    | :                    |
| Precinct, Police Officer Tiffany Martinez, Shield 2382 of | :                    |
| the 77 Precinct and New York City Police Officers John    | :                    |
| Doe,                                                      | :                    |
|                                                           | :                    |
| Defendants.                                               | :                    |
| -----X                                                    |                      |

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,  
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

**STATEMENT OF FACTS**

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Saquis Samuel, (hereinafter referred to as "SAMUEL") resides in Kings County, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Stephanie Perez, Shield 26230 of the 77 Precinct, (hereinafter referred to as "PEREZ") was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Police Officer Tiffany Martinez, Shield 2382 of the 77 Precinct, (hereinafter referred to as "MARTINEZ") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. New York City Police Officers John Doe, those officers involved in the arrest of SAMUEL, (hereinafter referred to as "DOES) were employed by the New York City Police Department.
5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.
6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.
7. On or about September 17, 2019 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.
8. On or about May 4, 2020 a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was conducted. At said hearing, Plaintiffs testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiffs' claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed.
9. That on or about September 15, 2019 at 12:00 AM in the vicinity of Atlantic Avenue and Nostrand Avenue, Brooklyn NY, Plaintiff was on driving home from visiting with his family when he was stopped, handcuffed and arrested by PEREZ, MARTINEZ and DOES.
10. That at no time had Plaintiff been engaged in any illegal or unlawful activity.
11. That at no time had Plaintiff operated a motor vehicle with excessive tints on the windows.

12. That at no time did Plaintiff possess a controlled substance.
13. That at no time did Plaintiff possess marijuana.
14. That after Plaintiff was arrested he was transported to the 77 precinct.
15. That when Plaintiff was removed to the 77 precinct he was subjected to a strip search and that nothing of an illegal nature was recovered.
16. That while at the 77 precinct, he was placed into a cell with other males for several hours.
17. That after several hours of being held in a cell at the 77 precinct, Plaintiff was removed to Kings County Central Booking located at 120 Schermerhorn Street, Brooklyn, NY.
18. That while at Kings County Central Booking, Plaintiff was held in a cell with other males for several hours.
19. That prior to Plaintiff's arraignment, Plaintiff hired a private attorney to represent him in court.
20. That on or about September 16, 2019 Plaintiff was arraigned on docket CR-034049-KN where he was charged with Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Seventh Degree, Unlawful Possession of Marijuana and Improper Coating on Side Windows.
21. At the time of Plaintiff's arraignment, his case was dismissed upon application of the Office of the Kings County District Attorney.

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST THE CITY OF NEW YORK  
AND NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

22. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 21, as if more fully stated herein at length.

23. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

24. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

25. That as a result of the actions by Defendants, Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from that day and onward.

26. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

27. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days of work.

28. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was forced to miss multiple days of school.

29. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS**

30. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 29, as if more fully stated herein at length.

31. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution by Defendants violated the rights of the Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

32. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff, did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward him and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS**

33. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 32, as if more fully stated herein at length.

34. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS**

35. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 34, as if more fully stated herein at length.

36. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

37. That during the pendency of the case, Defendants maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff by continuing to cooperate in a prosecution when Plaintiff should never have been arrested.

Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

38. That prior to the time of arrest, after the arrest and during the pendency of the criminal case against Plaintiff, PEREZ, MARTINEZ and DOES persisted in their false claim that Plaintiff possessed a controlled substance and marijuana despite knowing that he did not. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

39. That prior to the time of arrest, after the arrest and during the pendency of the criminal case against Plaintiff, PADIN, VIDAL and DOES persisted in their false claim that Plaintiff's vehicle had tinted windows beyond the lawful amount permitted. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND  
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

40. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 39, as if more fully stated herein at length.

41. At all times pertinent hereto, PEREZ, MARTINEZ and DOES were acting within the scope of her employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

42. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that PEREZ, MARTINEZ and DOES committed within the scope of her employment.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND  
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

43. Plaintiffs repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 42, as if more fully stated herein at length.

44. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to PEREZ, MARTINEZ and DOES constitutes a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

45. The City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a policy of arresting people and claiming that they possessed controlled substances when in fact they did not.

46. The City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a policy of not disciplining or terminating police officers who engaged in claiming that people possessed controlled substances when they did in fact not.

47. The City of New York and New York Police Department were aware that PEREZ had a substantiated Civilian Complaint Review Board finding for Abuse of Authority under complaint number 201810598 wherein she purposefully damaged property that belonged to someone else. Despite such, the City of New York continued to employ PEREZ.

48. The City of New York and New York Police Department were aware that PEREZ had a substantiated Civilian Complaint Review Board finding for Abuse of Authority under complaint number 201704687 wherein she unlawfully conducted the search of a person. Despite such, the City of New York continued to employ PEREZ.

49. The City of New York and New York Police Department were aware that PEREZ had a substantiated Civilian Complaint Review Board finding for being Discourteous under complaint number 201810598 wherein she used unprofessional language in the course of her professional duties. Despite such, the City of New York continued to employ PEREZ.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK  
AND NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

50. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 49, as if more fully stated herein at length.

51. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

52. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiffs each demand judgment against the Defendants as follows:

**On the first cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

**On the second cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

**On the third cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

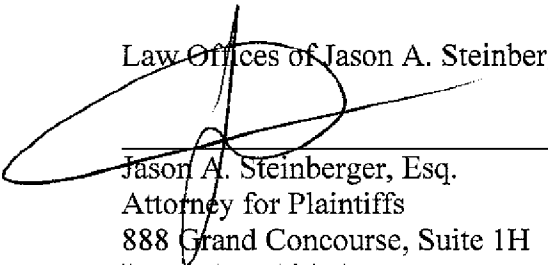
**On the fourth cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the wanton and willful nature of the Defendants actions;

**On the fifth cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

**On the sixth cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

**On the seventh cause of action**, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC



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Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.

Attorney for Plaintiffs

888 Grand Concourse, Suite 1H

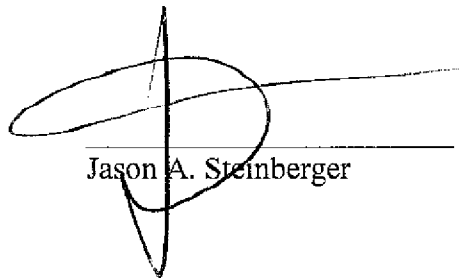
Bronx, NY 10451

(718) 585-2833

## STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF BRONX

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: September 24, 2020



Jason A. Steinberger